Argumentative AI

Measures and RQs

- **RQ1**: Does AI advocacy intensity produce measurable differences in the **alignment** between participants' final rankings and the AI's proposed ranking?
- **RQ2**: Does AI advocacy intensity influence the level of **state psychological reactance** experienced during the interaction? Specifically, does stronger advocacy produce greater perceived freedom restriction and state anger?
- **RQ3**: Does **trait psychological reactance** moderate the effect of advocacy intensity on AI alignment? Specifically, do high-reactance participants show lower alignment in the 100% condition than in the 50% condition?

IV

- Advocacy level

DV

- AI Alignment (AI vs Final)
- Self-Alignment (Self vs Final)
- State psychological reactance
- **Suggestion**: Threat to freedom

Covariates

- Trait psychological reactance
- Initial AI Alignment (AI vs Self)

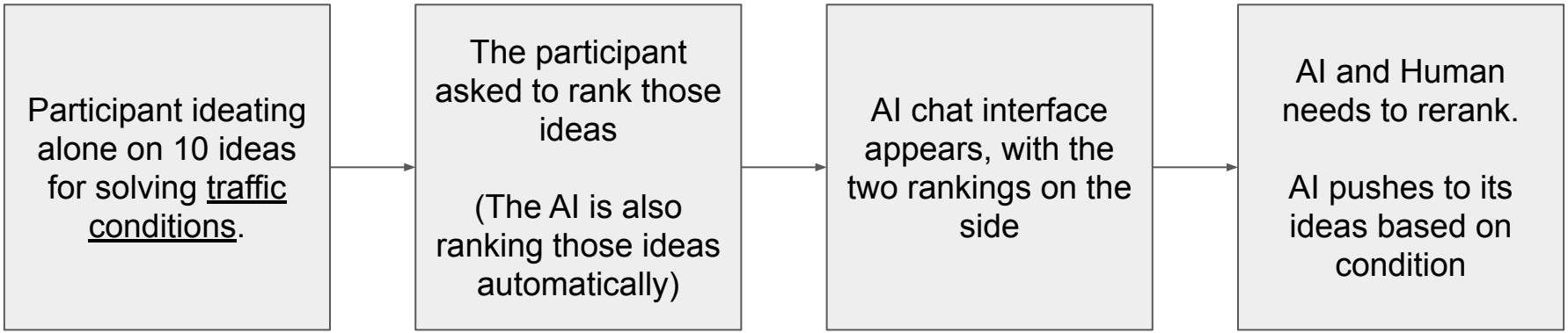
Study Plan - 3 conditions

C1 - Near Baseline (10%/0%): When first presenting its counter-ranking, the AI may briefly note one reason for its top-ranked idea. It does not argue further.

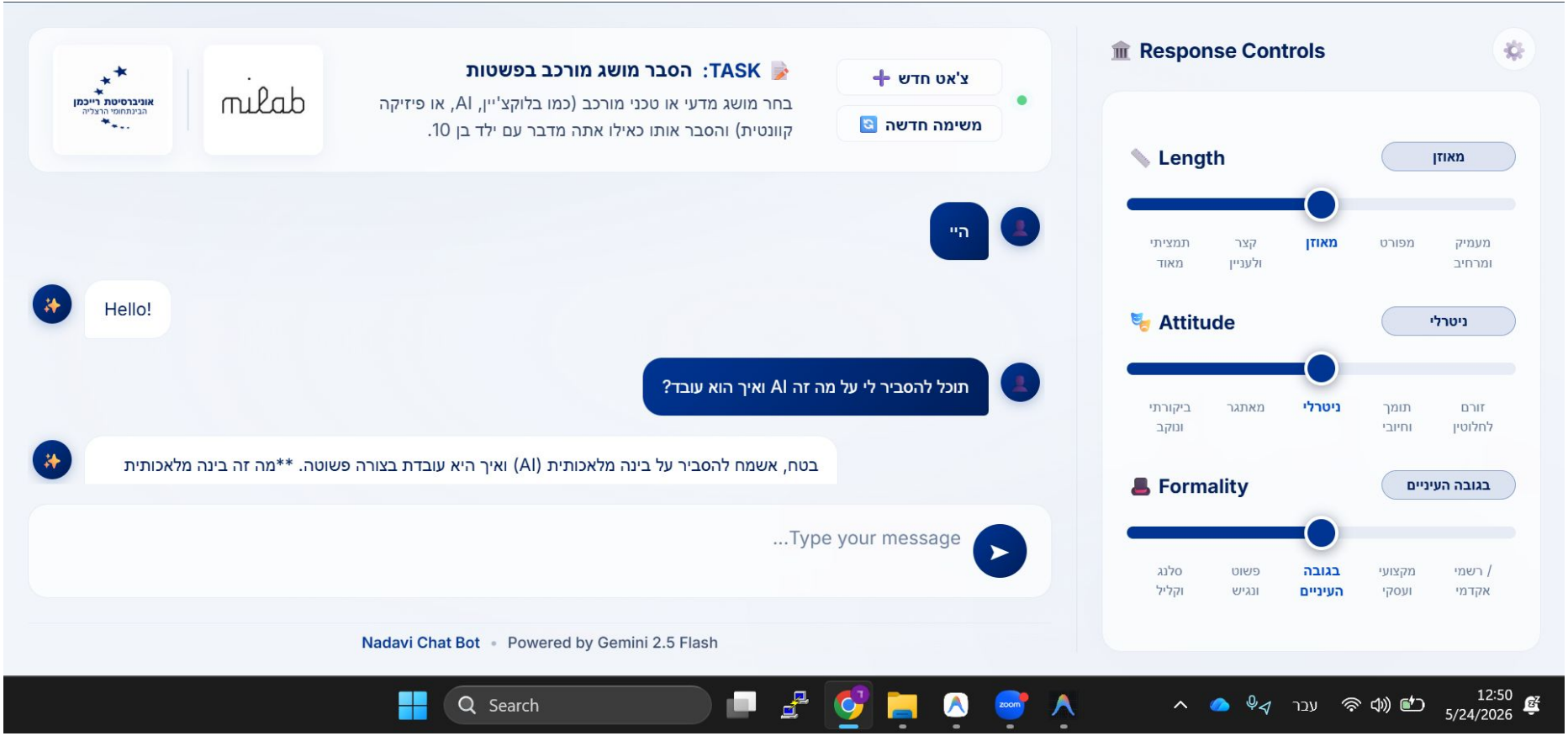
C2 - Moderate Advocacy (30%): The AI offers one reasoned argument per contested item. If the participant pushes back, the AI may offer one additional supporting point. It does not argue for items where its ranking already matches the participant's.

C3 - Strong Advocacy (70%): The AI argues for its preferred ranking, counter-argues the participant's reasoning when challenged, and maintains its position through two rounds of direct disagreement per item, conceding only at the third challenge. It opens by acknowledging agreement on items where rankings align, establishing credibility before advocating for contested positions.

Experiment Settings



Unbox AI


אוניברסיטת רייכמן
הבינתחומי הרצליה
milab
TASK: הסבר מושג מורכב בפשטות
בחר מושג מדעי או טכני מורכב (כמו בלוקצ'יין, AI, או פיזיקה קוונטית) והסבר אותו כאילו אתה מדבר עם ילד בן 10.
צ'אט חדש
משימה חדשה
Response Controls
Length
מאוזן
מעמיק ומרחיב
מפורט
מאוזן
קצר ולעניין
תמציתי מאוד
Attitude
ניטרלי
זורם לחלוטין
תומך וחיובי
ניטרלי
מאתגר
ביקורתי ונוקב
Formality
בגובה העיניים
רשמי / אקדמי
מקצועי ועסקי
בגובה העיניים
פשוט ונגיש
סלנג וקליל
היי
Hello!
תוכל להסביר לי על מה זה AI ואיך הוא עובד?
בטח, אשמח להסביר על בינה מלאכותית (AI) ואיך היא עובדת בצורה פשוטה. **מה זה בינה מלאכותית
Type your message...
Nadavi Chat Bot • Powered by Gemini 2.5 Flash
Search
עבר
12:50
5/24/2026

First Study - Unbox AI

- **RQ1**: Does control over an AI's voice parameters increase psychological ownership and perceived authorship of the text the AI writes for the participant?
- **RQ2**: Is visibility without control (C2) beneficial relative to no visibility (C1) , or will the visibility and lack of control will create friction?
- **RQ3**: Do these effects scale with the participant's preference–setting discrepancy (the mismatch between the AI's locked voice and the participant's own professional style)?
- **RQ4 (Qualitative)**: What are the strategies participant implements when the exposure and control level to the algorithm opaque system changes?

IV

- Exposure level

DV

- Felt Psychological Ownership
- Perceived Authorship (mine vs written by me)
- Perceived Authenticity
- Perceived Control

Amount of prompts, amount changes, amount of prompts after the button turned on.

We’re not measuring it but:

- Optional for discussion: Psychological Reactance (lack of freedom may lead to resistance)

First Study - Unbox AI

C1 - Hidden: The Response Controls panel is not displayed. Participants see only the chat window. Sliders are set to baseline values server-side without participant awareness.

Baseline Values:

- Verbosity = 2 (slightly concise)
- Hedging-Certainty = 4 (more assertive)
- Self-Promotion = 4 (more bold)

C2 - Visible, locked: The Response Controls panel is displayed. Sliders are set to baseline values and are non-interactive (visually locked). Participants can see the slider positions but cannot adjust them.

Baseline Values:

- Verbosity = 2 (slightly concise)
- Hedging-Certainty = 4 (more assertive)
- Self-Promotion = 4 (more bold)

C3 - Visible, controllable: The Response Controls panel is displayed. Sliders are interactive. Participants may adjust them at any time during the conversation. All slider interactions are logged.

Baseline Values:

- Verbosity = 2 (slightly concise)
- Hedging-Certainty = 4 (more assertive)
- Self-Promotion = 4 (more bold)

Experiment Settings

